Officers Shot in Active Shooter Incidents: 2000 - 2025

Codebook

ALERRT Center, Texas State University

September 2026



Contents

Overview 1
Identifiers 2
Incident 3
Officer situation 5
Officer location 6
Hits 8
Armor, weapon, and friendly fire 9
Text columns 10

Data file: `officer_shot_data_v2025.csv` (missing values blank). Codebook for the build of 2026-09-29: 75 incidents, 156 officers, 42 columns. Counts shown in this codebook are from that build.

Overview

Unit of observation

One row per law enforcement officer shot during an active shooter incident. Officers shot in the same incident share a `case_id`. The 75 incidents run from 2000-01-01 to 2025-12-31.

Who counts as shot

An officer is included when struck by gunfire during the incident. This includes:

- gunshot wounds and grazes;
- rounds stopped by body armor, a helmet, or equipment worn on the body (for example, a holstered firearm);
- injuries from bullet fragments (pieces of the bullet itself) and ricochets;
- officers struck by another officer's gunfire (coded in `blue_on_blue`).

Injuries only from glass, sheetrock, or other debris broken by gunfire are excluded, as are injuries unrelated to gunfire (for example, an officer hurt while rendering aid). Off-duty officers are included only when they were acting as police; an off-duty officer working a uniformed paid-detail post counts. National Guard members are not included, even when deputized. An injury described only as "shrapnel" is excluded unless a source says bullet fragments or ALERRT counts the officer as shot. An officer whose status is disputed is included when an official source (prosecutor, attorney general, FBI LEOKA, or the agency) describes a gunfire injury.

Conventions

- **Blank means unknown or not documented.** No column uses 99, NA, or text placeholders for missing values.
- **Dummy codes** are 1 = yes, 0 = no.
- **Incident-level columns** hold the same value on every row of a case. **Officer-level columns** describe the individual officer.

- **Text columns** (`loc_detail`, `shot_count_notes`, `hit_location_notes`, `notes`, `notes_other`) are the last five columns. They are free text that records the source detail behind the coded values.
- **Attackers are not named.** Following the ALERRT Center's policy, the free-text columns refer to "the attacker" where a source named the person.
- `officer_id` is stored as text so that officer 30.10 does not read as 30.1. Read it as text when opening the CSV (spreadsheet programs and default CSV readers will otherwise convert it to a number).

Sources

Coding came from news reports, agency and prosecutor reports, FBI LEOKA officer-level records, and court records. Incidents are linked to the ALERRT Active Attack Data (activeattackdata.org, v2025 release), which supplies `aad_case_code`, `n_victims_shot`, and `aad_resolution`.

Identifiers

case_id

Incident number, 1 to 75. Numbers follow date order except case 43 (Lakewood, WA, 2009), which was added after the others. Level: incident.

aad_case_code

The incident's `case_code` in the ALERRT Active Attack Data (v2025). Blank for case 27, which is not in the ALERRT data. Level: incident.

officer_id

Officer identifier, `case.officer` (for example, `2.1`, `30.10`). Stored as text. Numbers are not reused, so gaps mark officers removed during cleaning. Level: officer.

officer_name

The officer's name as "Last, First" when publicly released. Blank when the name was not released or could not be tied to a specific row; `officer_id` identifies the row either way. A released name is placed on a row only when the row's details (wound, location, agency, killed or wounded) match that officer. Otherwise the name is left blank and the released names are listed in the case notes. 133 officers are named; 23 are blank. Level: officer.

Incident

city, state

The place where the officers were shot. When officers were shot in more than one place, this is where the first officer was shot. `city` is the municipality or Census-designated place. When the first officer was shot outside any municipality, `city` is the nearest Census place and `loc_detail` or the notes say so. `state` is the two-letter postal code. Level: incident.

date

Date of the incident (yyyy-mm-dd), the first day of the attack. When an officer was shot on a later day, that officer's `notes` give the date (seven officers in three cases were shot the day after the incident date). Level: incident.

n_victims_shot

All people shot by the attacker during the incident: civilians, officers, and security guards, not counting the attacker. The value is ALERRT's `shot_tot` for the incident. For case 27, which is not in the ALERRT data, it comes from open sources. Because it is ALERRT's count, its officer component can differ from `n_officers_shot` (see the note under that variable). Officers shot only by other officers are not counted: in case 26 the attacker shot no one, so the value is 0. Range 0 to 102. Level: incident.

n_officers_shot, n_officers_killed, n_officers_wounded

Number of officers shot, killed, and wounded in the incident. These are counted from the officer rows, so `n_officers_shot` always equals the number of rows in the case and killed plus wounded always equals shot. Killed includes officers who died of their wounds later. Level: incident.

`n_officers_shot` follows this dataset's inclusion rule, not ALERRT's. It differs from ALERRT's officer count (`shot_le_tot`) in 17 of the 74 linked cases, mainly because this dataset counts armor, helmet, and holster strikes, fragment injuries, and officers shot by other officers, and excludes officers hurt only by glass or debris.

resolution

How the incident ended for the attacker. Level: incident. Cases shown.

Value	Definition	Cases
Killed by LE	Died of police gunfire, at any point (including later, away from the scene)	42
Shot by LE	Shot by police and survived, including when police gunfire led him to surrender	12
Suicide after LE arrival	Killed himself after police arrived, including when an officer was already on scene as a victim	13
Surrendered	Gave up without being shot	5
Arrested	Taken into custody without surrendering and without being shot	1
Suicide attempt	Shot himself and survived	1
Killed by Good Samaritan	Killed by an armed civilian	1

aad_resolution

The ALERRT Active Attack Data `resolution` value, kept as ALERRT records it, so the two schemes can be compared. ALERRT records how the attack itself ended, while `resolution` records the attacker's final outcome, so the two differ for attackers who fled the scene. Blank for case 27. Level: incident.

Value (ALERRT)	Cases
Shot by police	49
Suicide after police arrival	9
Fled	8
Surrendered	4
Shot by off duty officer	1
Subdued by police	1
Shot by citizen	1
Suicide before police arrival	1
Blank (not in ALERRT)	1

explosives

Dummy. 1 if the attacker brought a device built to explode or ignite (pipe bomb, improvised explosive device, grenade, Molotov cocktail, or incendiary device), used or not, or propane tanks staged to detonate. Smoke grenades and fires set with accelerant do not count. Level: incident. 1 = 8 cases, 0 = 67.

attacker_armor

Dummy. 1 if sources describe the attacker wearing body armor or an armored, ballistic, or tactical vest, unless a source says the vest was not ballistic. Plates do not need to be confirmed. 0 when no armor is described. Level: incident. 1 = 12 cases, 0 = 63.

Officer situation

officer_action

What the officer was doing when the incident reached them. Level: officer.

Value	Definition	Officers
Response	Responding to a call the officer knew involved a shooting or active shooter	114
Duty	On duty but not responding to a shooting: normal duties, a post, a traffic stop, a welfare check, or happening to be present	42

`officer_action` and `ambush` are coded separately. A Duty officer is not automatically ambushed.

pursuit

Dummy. 1 if officers were actively following a fleeing attacker, in a vehicle or on foot, when this officer was shot, including the moment a stop or chase begins. Searching an area for an attacker who fled earlier is 0, as is a standoff after officers followed the attacker to a location. Pursuit describes how the encounter came about, not where the officer was; the officer's position is in the location columns. Level: officer. 1 = 15, 0 = 141.

ambush

Dummy. 1 if the attacker set out to surprise the officers: either ambushing officers to start the attack (for example, firing on officers at a post or a traffic stop to begin it) or starting something to draw police and then ambushing the officers who came (for example, a 911 call made to lure them). Officers responding to a call they knew was a shooting are not coded as ambushed just because the attacker was concealed, had taken a position, or fired first. Level: officer. 1 = 50, 0 = 106.

ambush_type

The officer's situation when ambushed. Blank when `ambush` = 0. Level: officer.

Value	Definition	Officers
Call	Responding to a call for service, as the primary officer or as backup (including a call placed to lure police)	23
Post	Standing at a fixed post or assignment	14
Other	Ambushed on duty but not at a post or on a call (for example, on a meal break, sitting in a patrol car, leaving a ceremony)	13

Every officer who joins a call is `Call`, whether they took the call or came to back up the officer who did.

officer_killed

Dummy. 1 if the officer died of the wounds, including later deaths. Level: officer. 1 = 35, 0 = 121.

Officer location

Location is coded at the moment the officer was first hit. When an officer was hit in more than one position, the later hits are described in `loc_detail` or the notes.

loc_outside

Dummy. 1 if the officer was outside a building when shot, 0 if inside. Blank for one officer (70.2) whose position is not documented. Level: officer. 1 = 117, 0 = 38.

loc_inside_type

Where inside the building the officer was shot. Blank for officers outside. Level: officer.

Value	Definition	Officers
Hallway	Hallway or corridor, including an elevator landing	13
Room	Inside a room, including a store sales floor or open work area	11
Entryway	Just inside the building entrance: lobby, vestibule, front desk	7
Stairwell	Stairwell or staircase	2
Unknown	Inside, but where in the building is not documented	5

An officer shot in a doorway is coded by where the officer was standing.

loc_outside_type

Where the officer was when shot outside a building. Blank for officers inside. Apply the categories in this order. Level: officer.

Value	Definition	Officers
Inside Car	Still in the vehicle	23
Next to Car	Out of the vehicle and immediately beside it, including using it as cover	17
Moving	On foot and advancing toward the scene or the attacker	37
Stationary	On foot and not moving: at a post or checkpoint, rendering aid, or behind cover that is not a vehicle while engaging without moving	9
Outside Car	Out of the vehicle, not beside it, with no information that the officer was advancing or stationary; also an officer retreating or running for cover	17
Unknown	Outside, but the position is not documented	14

loc_all

Combined location. Takes the `loc_inside_type` value for officers inside and the `loc_outside_type` value for officers outside. Unknown positions are `Unknown inside` or `Unknown outside`. Set automatically from the two type columns. Level: officer.

loc_in_car, loc_out_car, loc_moving, loc_unclear

Location dummies, set automatically from `loc_all`. Level: officer.

Dummy	1 when `loc_all` is	Officers = 1
loc_in_car	Inside Car	23
loc_out_car	Next to Car or Outside Car	34
loc_moving	Moving	37
loc_unclear	Unknown inside or Unknown outside	19

All four are 0 for Hallway, Room, Entryway, Stairwell, and Stationary. All four are blank for the one officer with no documented location.

Hits

Rounds stopped by body armor, a helmet, or equipment on the body count as hits throughout this section. A vest strike is a torso hit and a helmet strike is a head hit.

shot_multiple

Dummy. 1 if the officer was hit by more than one round. Set to 1 only for separate wounds that could not come from a single round (entry and exit wounds, or one round passing through two body parts, count as one). Blank when sources do not settle it. Level: officer. 1 = 36, 0 = 91, blank = 29.

shot_count

Number of rounds that hit the officer, set only when a source states the number of rounds or wounds. One shotgun shell counts as one hit, however many pellets struck. Blank otherwise. Level: officer.

Rounds	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	15	Blank
Officers	70	11	3	1	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	62

hit_location

The specific place the officer was hit (for example, Arm, Leg, Hand, Head, Face, Neck, Torso, Back, Hip, Shoulder, Knee, Calf, Pelvic area). `Multiple` when the officer was hit in more than one region. Blank when not documented. Level: officer.

hit_severe

The most severe region hit. When the officer was hit in more than one region, the most severe is coded. Blank when not documented. Level: officer.

Value (most to least severe)	Includes	Officers
Head	Head, face, and neck	37
Torso	Chest, back, abdomen, pelvis, hip, and waist, including the gun belt	36
Extremities	Shoulders, arms, hands, legs, knees, and feet	57
Blank	Not documented	26

Neck is grouped with Head rather than kept as its own region: neck wounds, like head wounds, are immediately life-threatening (major blood vessels, airway, spinal cord), and a separate level would hold only a handful of officers. `hit_location` keeps Neck, so neck wounds can still be separated out.

hit_head

Dummy. 1 if the officer was hit anywhere in the head region (head, face, or neck), including helmet strikes, whether or not it was the most severe wound. Glass or debris injuries do not count. Always 1 when `hit_severe` is Head. Blank when where the officer was hit is not documented. Level: officer. 1 = 37, 0 = 93, blank = 26.

hit_torso

Dummy. 1 if the officer was hit anywhere in the torso region, including vest strikes, whether or not it was the most severe wound. An officer shot in the head and chest is 1 on both `hit_head` and `hit_torso`. Blank when not documented. Level: officer. 1 = 45, 0 = 85, blank = 26.

Armor, weapon, and friendly fire

blue_on_blue

Dummy. 1 if the officer was shot by another officer during the incident. Blank when sources raise the possibility but no finding settles it (73.1, 73.2). Level: officer. 1 = 3, 0 = 151, blank = 2.

officer_armor

Dummy. 1 if sources document the officer wearing a ballistic vest (including rounds that struck or passed through the vest), 0 if sources document that the officer was not wearing one, and blank if not documented. Helmets are not counted. Level: officer. 1 = 56, 0 = 6, blank = 94.

weapon

The type of weapon that hit this officer. When sources do not say which weapon hit the officer, this is the attacker's primary weapon (ALERRT `weapon_primary`), unless information about the incident conflicts with that. AR-15-style pistols firing rifle cartridges are coded Rifle. Level: officer.

Value	Definition	Officers
Rifle	Rifle, including AR-15-style pistols	79
Handgun	Handgun	62
Shotgun	Shotgun	14
Handgun / Rifle	Hit by both (for example, the attacker's handgun and another officer's rifle)	1

Text columns

The last five columns are free text. They record the source detail behind the coded values and are not meant for analysis directly.

loc_detail

Where the officer was shot, in words (for example, "West parking lot of Mercy Hospital, rendering aid"). Backs up `loc_outside`, `loc_inside_type`, and `loc_outside_type`, and describes later positions when an officer was hit in more than one place. Level: officer.

shot_count_notes

Detail on the hits: conflicting counts across sources, pellet counts, armor strikes. Backs up `shot_multiple` and `shot_count`. Level: officer.

hit_location_notes

The wounds and their sources. Backs up `hit_location`, `hit_severe`, `hit_head`, and `hit_torso`. Level: officer.

notes

The incident and the officer: how the encounter unfolded, released names not tied to a row, and the date an officer was shot when it was after the incident date. Level: officer.

notes_other

Additional detail, mainly about the incident, that does not fit elsewhere. Level: officer.